



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate

JAN 2021

Are you on
Facebook?
Join our private
Minnehaha
Community Page!



About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

minnehaha Winter Celebration

*January 25th-30th
with Zoom Gathering for All Ages
on Saturday, Jan 30th from 10-11am*

WATCH FOR MORE DETAILS FOR ACTIVITIES YOU CAN PARTICIPATE IN
FROM YOUR HOMES THROUGHOUT THE WEEK.

FIRST TASK: PHOTOGRAPH THE MINNEHAHA "M" IN YOUR HOME.

YOU CAN USE EITHER OF THE ATTACHED:
THE STANDARD VERSION, OR THE OUTLINE FOR YOU TO DECORATE,
OR YOU CAN CREATE AN "M" OUT OF SNOW! FOOTPRINTS! YOUR DINNER!
OR WHATEVER ELSE YOU CAN THINK OF.



minnehaha
UNITED METHODIST CHURCH

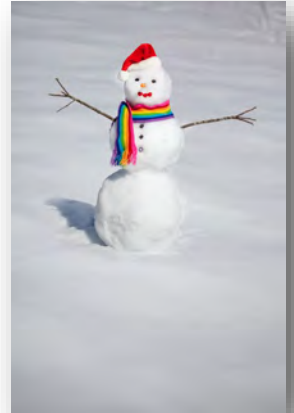


minnehaha
UNITED METHODIST CHURCH

Worship in January

January starts a new year! With much of our worship life remaining the same – online. We anticipate remaining online only until we can worship again outside this summer, so no fear, you can worship in your jammies for the foreseeable future! In January, we enter into the season of Epiphany. It starts with the visit of the Magi, and quickly progresses to Jesus' baptism at age 30 (the next week!), and then we hear a variety of stories the challenge us to follow Jesus, even when that call is difficult. We'll have a special service on January 17 featuring music from Black/African-American composers and readings from local black poets, playwrights, and writers.

January 3	"Let Your Light Shine" - Epiphany <i>Isaiah 60:1-6</i>
January 10 Recognition	"Moving With the Holy Spirit" - Baptism Sunday/Infant <i>Mark 1:4-11</i>
January 17	Martin Luther King Sunday
January 24	"Following Jesus" <i>Mark 1:14-20</i>
January 31	"With Authority" <i>Mark 1:21-28</i>



Newcomer Class

We'll be holding an introduction and orientation class for anyone new to Minnehaha or interested in joining on Thursday, January 7 at 6:30 via zoom. If you have been attending our worship services and want to know a little bit more about us, this is the opportunity to do that! We'll send you the zoom link directly, so if you are interested, please contact Becky Sechrist at becky@minnehaha.org. Our next class (also on zoom) will be held on Saturday, February 6

Annual Meeting

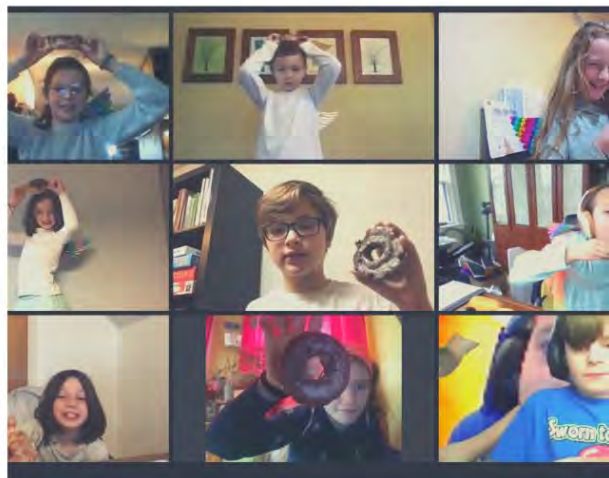
Our Annual Meeting (otherwise known as a Church Conference) will be held on Tuesday, January 19, 2021 at 6:30 on zoom. We'll send a link to the meeting in your enews that week. The Annual Meeting will hear our year-end financial report, approve the 2021 budget, and receive the membership report.

Office Closed

I know that we are not really "in" the office, but the staff will be taking a much-needed break the week following Christmas. Emails and calls left for any of them may go unanswered until after the New Year!

MINNEHAHA CHILDREN, YOUTH, & FAMILIES

Looking back at December together...apart...

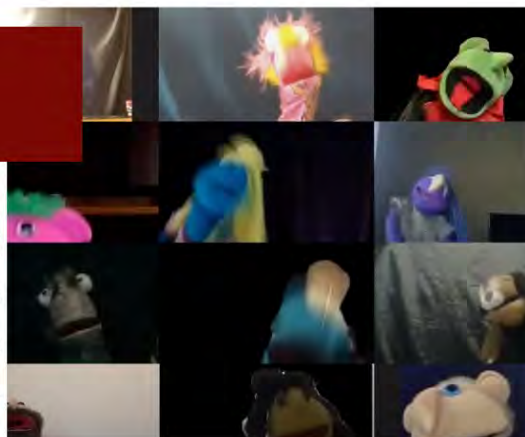


CHILDREN

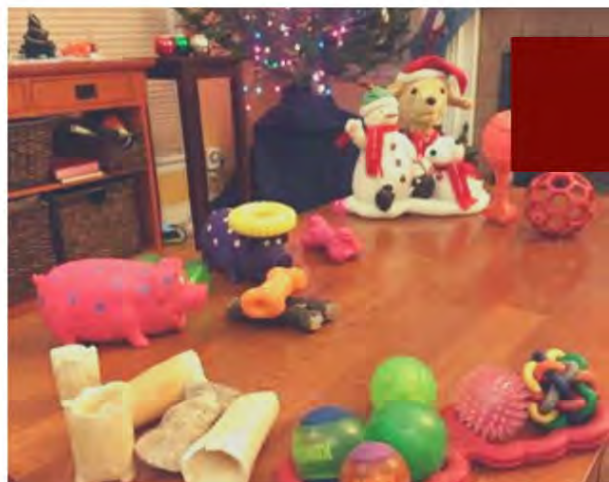
Each week, we lit Advent Candles together during our Zoom Sunday School: talking about what gives us HOPE, what song brings us PEACE, and what in our homes brings us JOY. We put the finishing touches on the Pageant, and celebrated with a Pajama Pageant Watch Party.

YOUTH

Chocolate crinkles and gingerbread, puppets and star wars, stars and snowflakes: We gathered throughout the month, via the magic of Zoom, to create and connect, to reflect and lift up.



FAMILIES



With the Nativity Scene Challenge - we got peaks into people's homes and creativity. We observed Advent with our "Do Not Be Afraid" devotional. We enjoyed the collaboration of all ages for our socially-distanced Christmas Pageant.

Pledges

If you haven't gotten in your pledge for the 2021 Operating Budget, please do so right away. We will be passing our annual budget mid-January and we'd like as accurate a number as we can for our If you didn't get a pledge card, or need another one, please contact the office to get a new one. Thank you!

United Methodist Women

Still looking for a Christmas gift? Minnehaha UMW has some items that would be great gifts: 1 pound of fantastic Wild Rice for \$15, 2 pounds for \$30, Bean soup mixes, \$5, Minnehaha UMW Cookbooks for \$5, kitchen towels with crocheted handles for \$7.50, net scrubbies \$2 and a variety of different homemade jams/jellies \$4. Please order by calling Maureen Trepp at 612-387-2520 (leave a message!), or maureentrepp@yahoo.com and we'll find a way to deliver and collect payment. All proceeds go to the missions supported by the UMW.

Minnehaha Infant Recognition

SUNDAY, JANUARY 10TH - VIA ONLINE WORSHIP

We'll be celebrating babies born in the Minnehaha community during 2020.

If your family's had a baby this year, please **complete the attached form** with information to aid us in our celebration.

And, mark your calendars for a **Young Families Coffee Hour at 10:30am** that day as well.





Winter Celebration!

We can't do the winter retreat this year, but that doesn't mean we can't have some fun! There is more information elsewhere in the newsletter, so look for a graphic with snowflakes, but the upshot is that we are asking you to make the Minnehaha logo or utilize the Minnehaha logo somewhere in your home or neighborhood (or travels) and take a picture of it. You might make one out of snow (or, mow it into your lawn if this warmer weather continues . . .). You could make a cookie or bread, pose the logo by the Minnehaha Falls or use some creative work to make it appear as the star on top of your Christmas Tree. Whatever you do, we are going to share those results with each other (and with everyone) at the end of January.

Note
from the
pastor



The Future

As I write, the FDA has just approved emergency use of the Pfizer vaccine for Covid-19, and more companies are lined up for similar approval in the coming days and weeks. It certainly looks like light at the end of the tunnel. But, we are reminded, it is still a long tunnel. It will be awhile before more of the vaccines can be made, and they need to be distributed and administered, and it takes a little while before a vaccinated person's body builds up the immunity needed to protect them from infection. So, we'll be hanging tight for awhile, looking to summer or fall before many of the pandemic restrictions are truly lifted. So, more tunnel. But, light is there! This is as good a time as any to ponder what we want things to look like when we get to the end of that tunnel. Should life go back to what it was before the pandemic? What about all those who lost their jobs? Lost loved ones? Businesses that closed? Life certainly won't be the same for those folks. We certainly won't be taking for granted the ability to gather together as a physical community. And the ugly underside of our society and economy has also been exposed. When we get to the end of the tunnel, what will we do about rebuilding our communities in ways that don't have racism or sexism built in? How will we stay connected with people in our church (or our neighbors) whose physical restrictions mean that they can't come to the church building for worship or programs? The scriptures give us lots of examples of the call of God to live lives of justice and compassion. That's our challenge for this walk through the tunnel. Building a future of justice and compassion.

In Joy,

Becky





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